

Padma Prabha M

Information Science and Technology

Intern Analyst in Wells Fargo

About the Company:

Wells Fargo & Company (NYSE: WFC) is a leading financial services company that has approximately \$1.9 trillion in assets.

We provide a diversified set of banking, investment and mortgage products and services, as well as consumer and commercial finance, through our four reportable operating segments: Consumer Banking and Lending, Commercial Banking, Corporate and Investment Banking, and Wealth & Investment Management.

Wells Fargo ranked No. 34 on Fortune's 2024 rankings of America's largest corporations. In the communities we serve, the company focuses its social impact on building a sustainable, inclusive future for all by supporting housing affordability, small business growth, financial health, and a low-carbon economy.

Overview of the Process:

The overall process consisted of

- An Offline coding contest in SHL platform (Conducted in IST, CEG)
- Interview Round 1 (Based on Resume, Technical) – in MIT Campus
- Interview Round 2 (general, HR) – in MIT Campus

I applied for the following position:

R-389220 Intern Analyst

Online coding contest in SHL platform:

The coding contest was conducted in SHL platform. All the instructions given by the platform should be followed strictly like turning ON camera, microphones. The test is of 4 sections namely 2 aptitude sections and 2 coding sections.

The technical rules are you can't move to the next question without answering the current question. And once you have moved from a question, you can't move to that question. No negative markings.

The aptitude section:

- English aptitude.
- Business Analytics.

The 3rd section consisted of 2 coding questions. (40 mis)

1. Find the count of non-repeating alphabets in the given string.
2. You have two arrays with repeating positive integers. The count of the non-common numbers from the two arrays must be returned.

The 4th section consisted of only one question. (10 mins)

1. Graph Problem – The Famous Konigsberg Bridge Problem is described in detail and our task is to find the given graph ends up like the given bridge or can it be solvable. Then return true if solvable or false if unsolvable.

22 students were shortlisted for interview process of Intern Analyst.

TIPS for Aptitude Sections:

- Have a basic English Knowledge. Connect the question with each of the 4 given options. If you don't know the answer then don't get stressed, stay calm and answer according to your conscious, believe on your 1st choice.
- Logical Thinking is the key along with some maths. For business analytics kind of questions, read the entire question because the answer will be just hidden in.
- Practice speed math, just a transferable skill. Trust me it helps a lot.

Interview Round 1: (45-50 mins)

(Based on Resume)

This round was purely based on our Resume. The questions were general. There were 4 panels (each with one member) 2 panel for Round 1 and 2 panel for Round 2. Questions and their complexity depends on the panel you go. Some panel members can test your deep technical knowledge in both rounds (purely depends upon the interviewers).

Sir named Basker is my interviewer. After going through my resume he started to ask the following questions:

- First, are you ready to start the interview?
- Introduce yourself.

- You have mentioned some projects in your resume, do you do these projects on your own interest or they are just part of your curriculum?
- Point the project that you have done apart from your curriculum (based on interest)

Sir started reading about that project.

- Why you chose hardware over software? (I like to work in embedded systems and IoT, hence I chose to work on that project)
- Explain me one project that you are confident on, from your resume.
- Can you explain me about the workshops you have attended?
- Is this project a continuation from the learning of the workshop?
- Explain me the idea of the hackathon and your contribution in it.
- Explain me the Gaming Projects that you have mentioned here.
- Shall we move to the Technical Side?

(Technical):

• I am going to ask questions from OOPS, DB, DSA. Choose one to start. I chose OOPS.

- Why do we need structing?
- What are the 4 main concepts of OOPS? Explain each in detail.
- What is a subclass?
- What is the main purpose for inheritance?
- Can you give me a real-life scenario where inheritance can be used?
- What do you know about file handling?
- Syntax to open, read/write and close a file.
- File handing – working mechanism.
- What is the need of error handling?
- Tell me some techniques of handling error.

DBMS

- What do you know about DBMS?
- What is querying?

- Do you have experience working with NoSQL?
- What are the 3 major commands in querying (DDL, DML, DCL)
- Explain each DDL, DML, DCL in detail.
- Tell me some of the aggregate functions.
- Write a Query to display the duplicates in field. (I used GROUP BY and COUNT)
- What is the need of indexing? (along with B, B+ trees)
- What is a view, why it is used?
- What is JOIN? Tell me about all its types and explain each in detail.
- Do you know about distributed DB?

DSA

- Tell me the types of DS. (Your answer should be from the base classification like linear and non-linear, then further explain each branch)
- Explain the mechanism of Stack and Queue.
- What do you know about tree DS?
- Write code to perform inorder – traversal along with drawing the Tree.
- Explain me about linked lists, its advantages and disadvantages over arrays, stack, queues.
- Sir asked me to draw all types of linked lists with max 3 nodes by mentioning the pointers.

CLOUD COMPUTING

- Do you know about Cloud Computing?
- What are the three major types in it?
- Name some cloud computing services that you know.

SOFTWARE PROCESS

- Have you studied software processes?
- Can you explain about Agile and SDLC?
- What are the main principles of Agile?
- Any questions for him?

TIPS:

- Take your time to think and phrase your answer, whenever possible.
- Answer short and crisp with confidence. (if mentioned to elaborate, then take your time)
- They weren't bothered about the syntax. They were fine with that.
- If you don't know even a bit of the answer/ unable to recall, be straight to the point and say "I don't Know"/ "I can't recall at this moment". Because it gives a hope on you that you are able to express your mind!
- Since the interview is 45 -50 mins, drink water if you dry out and relax yourself by breathing.

THEN: Round 2 has been conducted for all the 22 members.

Interview Round – 2: (30 mins)

NOTE: the entire convo went in mixed tamil(major) and english

Sir introduced himself, and told me to introduce myself.

- Ram sir asked about my studies how it was going.
- Then he told me that "lets reverse our roles", which means I want to ask questions (any question on earth) to him and he will be answering.
- I felt so nervous and decided to ask the first question that hits my mind.

Question: How did you get into Wells Fargo Sir?

Answer: sir explained me about his previous startups and how he joined Wells Fargo. He is working for like 15-18 years. (in wells fargo).

(I started to think so hard for next question – where I realised asking questions is more difficult than answering them!)

Question: How to improve communication in English sir?

Answer: he asked me "do anybody told that your English is bad or it is awesome?" I replied NO, then sir said don't hear what others say about you, you should be the one who validate yourself then he said communication is like a sport like cycling, swimming. The more you practice the more you improve.

Question: Sir this swapping of roles is interesting but why are you asking me to ask questions sir? How to helps you in knowing me? Is there anything so deep in this?

Answer: Sir's reply is like a life lesson. He said you are just a 4th semester completed student and you are just 19 right? But I have an experience of 15-18 years. Hence there is no point in asking technical questions to you. (I am frozen with a smile in my face)

See I recently learned MongoDB and with what I learnt I written a code. (my code worked correctly) But when I ask ChatGPT to do that it gave me 5 different answers which is far better than my code in both time and space complexity.

What do you understand from this he asked. I replied: "Prompting (asking questions and doubts) ...". He said, yes that's why I want you to ask questions.

Next: for the next question I started to think...sir said ok it's enough I will ask now

SIR STARTED ASKING HIS QUESTIONS

- What tool would you like to learn and develop?
- How was your round 1?
- What are you parents?
- Why you chose finance? What you know about it?
- What do you think Wells Fargo does to people?
- Again, any questions for me? (I said NO sir)

MY PREPARATION STRATEGY:

- I had a thought of preparing for internships in my 4th semester holiday, I even downloaded all the materials sent by our seniors for the first time, but I couldn't make it because I had to spend my holidays in my summer project, mostly family time, license works etc...
- When I got so bored I watched Striver's DSA Series (TUF) on youtube. – This man is everything in my preparation for CP.
- With some knowledge on competitive programming that I have practiced during my 3rd and 4th semesters I took my first online test for D.E.Shaw.
- After taking that test, coming out the lab, I was like "are you a paradoxical idiot? You are getting a good idea to solve that question, but don't know the syntax of STL"
- I clearly remember where I got stuck. Therefore, I decided to not repeat my mistakes.
- Next for company Vegrow, I improved somewhat and I am so happy that I didn't do any mistakes that I done for D.E.Shaw and but discovered some new mistakes!
- Then I realised that, there are great inbuilt lib in C++, then why I am not using them. So, I started learning all of them in the weekends I got (Saturday and Sunday)
- Then came Appian, I did my best (on understanding the question and solving)

- For Wells Fargo, the online test was on Monday, I got two days for my prep. And wrote the exam with all my mind, I did not do any mistakes and I did what I thought right for me.

I got selected for the interview (completed test at 7 pm – started at 5 pm, 12th August, results of interview shortlist came at 11:25 pm, where they mentioned tomorrow is your interview so be there on MIT campus at 8:00 am)

I got no time to read about the job description or either recall the important points for an interview (even introducing myself)

I went to MIT. They said interview will be starting at 10 am, then I started googling important topics for interview, how to give self-introduction and also read some news after a saturation point. They called me for round 1 at 11:20 am, I came out at 12:30 pm.

After lunch I got my second round, gave my best, then relaxed. (maximum try not to skip lunch, eating a bit)

SOME ADDITIONAL TIPS:

For Bio-maths students like me who are not exposed to any kind of programming languages, tools or softwares during their 11th and 12th grade, there are lots of online resources to learn coding, competitive programming and DSA.

Find your study method (the method by which you grasp new things quick and easy) and follow that kind of online resources.

Make good connections with seniors (trust me some seniors are great helpers they teach you by sharing their experiences).

Hope my words gave you a click about my experience, my prep and general interview process, I suggest you to have a look on all others experiences so that you will get to know different flavours of selection processes.

THANK YOU.

Padma Prabha M (3rd year IT - purple)